🦬 Day 3: Settlers and the Homestead Act: Daily Notes

US History · Unit 2 · Level 1 · The Heartland

Name: _____

🎯 *Today: How settlers lived on the Plains and the good and bad effects of expansion.*

🔁 Warm-up (5-minute review)

1. 🛒 Plains settlers burned dried buffalo and cow dung (“chips”) because…

- 🌳 **there were few trees for firewood**
- 🍫 **it smelled sweet**

📖 Learn

- 🏠 The **Homestead Act** (1862) gave 160 acres to settlers who farmed it for 5 years.
- 🧱 With few trees, settlers built **sod** houses from dirt and grass.
- 🔥 They burned buffalo and cow “**chips**” for fuel.
- 🏁 In the 1889 Oklahoma **land rush**, people raced to claim land.
- 🌾 Steel plows and **windmills** helped farmers on the dry Plains.

Fill in the word

2. The _____ (1862) gave 160 acres to settlers who farmed it for 5 years.

3. With few trees, settlers built _____ houses from dirt and grass.

4. They burned buffalo and cow "_____" for fuel.

5. In the 1889 Oklahoma _____, people raced to claim land.

Word bank: **chips** | **Homestead Act** | **land rush** | **sod**

Exit ticket

6. The Homestead Act gave settlers…

- **a car**
- **free land if they farmed it**